No Objection to Declassification in Full 2010/07/23 : LOC-HAK-467-5-1-7

MEMORANDUM

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

TOP SECRET/SENSITIVE/
EXCLUSIVELY EYES ONLY

January 6, 1972

MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION

PLACE: The Great Hall of the People
Peking, China

DATE: 11:00 A.M., January 6, 1972

PARTICIPANTS: Mr. CHI P'eng-fei, Acting Foreign Minister
Mr. HAN Hsu, Director, Protocol Department, MFA
General A. M. Haig, Jr.
Miss Nancy T'ang (Interpreter)

FM Chi: So you went to see the Palace Museum this morning?

Gen Haig: Yes, we had a most enjoyable visit there. It was just marvelous and extremely educational.

FM Chi: The only thing -- it is rather cold in the morning.

Gen Haig: It is cold, but it serves to wake you up.

FM Chi: Yes, it is good to wake you up.

Gen Haig: It also helps the appetite.

FM Chi: That is a good thing.

Gen Haig: I will do what Dr. Kissinger did while he was here -- put on weight. First, Mr. Minister, I thought I would like to just reiterate and reemphasize personally that I am very grateful for the personal cooperativeness that we are receiving at every level from your people. I am somewhat embarrassed to find that some of our people, have come with all the answers and have not operated with as much efficiency as I would have preferred. This has required additional patience and assistance from your side which has certainly not been lacking.

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FM Chi: I heard that they have had rather smooth and rather good discussions in the groups.

Gen Haig: Everything has been superior in the exchange of views but I find that the network people have sometimes not performed as effectively as I would have liked.

FM Chi: They seem to be doing alright.

Gen Haig: You are too kind. I did have some other followup information to our meetings of early Tuesday morning with the Prime Minister. I immediately reported in great detail that morning to Dr. Kissinger the results of the discussions with the Prime Minister. And he replied to me first that he received my report with no little nostalgia and he felt that in replying to my message that he wanted to again extend his personal greetings to each of you that had worked with him so cooperatively and in such a friendly spirit in October and July.

FM Chi: We would also like to thank him.

Gen Haig: One of the first items I mentioned to the Prime Minister was our hope that we could strengthen the positive actions of the Draft Communique. And when the Prime Minister replied to me he mentioned that this was primarily a problem of trade. I wanted to reemphasize that we were thinking also of cultural and scientific exchanges between the two sides -- that we might wish to consider improved language with respect to these two items as well as trade. In line with this, when Dr. Kissinger and the President come in February, they will have some additional proposals for exchange in the cultural and scientific area, as well as some ideas for your consideration in the area of trade, recognizing that this must come very slowly and it is not the kind of thing we would anticipate immediate action on but maybe some words of future promise. And we would welcome if between now and the visit you care to communicate further on this, perhaps in the Paris channel or, if you prefer, to wait until the party arrives and there could be some further discussion.

Concerning the draft alternative language I left ad referendum with respect to the U.S. portion of the paragraph on Taiwan, we would

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welcome any additional views which your side might have before I return to the United States and we would be prepared to accept and consider any additional or alternate language that you might care to give before I leave. In any event, we would anticipate that this subject would always be the result of direct exchanges here in Peking between you and myself while I am here or Dr. Kissinger and the President after they arrive.

Now, also, during the meeting on Tuesday morning, the Prime Minister conveyed the thought that he would welcome any additional views we have on the subject of South Asia and the subcontinent before any meetings with President Nixon. With your side's approval, we would like to send some additional views on this subject through the Paris channel between now and the 21st of February. And for now, I would like to emphasize that our policies there will focus on efforts to buy time and to strengthen the defense capabilities of Pakistan. We certainly share the Prime Minister's concern that that situation is far from settled and is still in a period of dynamism which will require the most careful watching and perhaps action on both our parts. We have been using our influence just before and since the cease-fire to get Turkey and France to help in the arms situation in Pakistan.

FM Chi: Turkey and France?

Gen Haig: Yes. Turkey and France and this was a topic discussed between Presidents Nixon and Pompidou in the Azores. Concurrently, we are starting up our economic program for Pakistan at a greater level of assistance than heretofore. Now, turning to the topic of Southeast Asia which was also discussed with the Prime Minister on Tuesday morning, Dr. Kissinger has asked me to reiterate our government's view that it is Moscow which is blocking the arrival at a peaceful negotiated settlement of the conflict. He has asked me to recount in somewhat greater detail the sweeping proposals which we have made in search of a settlement of the conflict. We had, as I stated earlier, a meeting scheduled for the 20th of November with representatives of Hanoi in Paris. They cancelled that meeting and since that time, we have heard nothing from Hanoi.

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Vietnam, as Dr. Kissinger stated in October, is an anguishing problem for our government. In this sense, it was not the Nixon Administration that got us into the conflict but he, of course, has the problem of terminating the conflict.

Dr. Kissinger has also asked me to emphasize that when he met with Mr. Le Duc Tho in Paris in July, after the visit to Peking, he informed Mr. Le Duc Tho that the United States wished to end the war in Hanoi and not in Peking. During the past year, we have done the following specific things with respect to the conflict:

- On May 31st of last year, Dr. Kissinger met with Minister Xuan Thuy and proposed seven U.S. points for ending the war. One of these points was an offer on our part to set a deadline for our withdrawal.

- Then, on June 26th, Mr. Le Duc Tho came to Paris and met secretly with Dr. Kissinger. At that time, Hanoi proposed nine points in reply to the seven points we had proposed in May.

- Then, on July 1st, Madame Binh published her seven points and as Dr. Kissinger pointed out to the Prime Minister in October it was very odd procedure from our perspective to be given nine points secretly and seven points publicly.

- So, on July 12th, on his return from Peking, Dr. Kissinger met with Mr. Le Duc Tho in Paris, again secretly, and at this meeting we inquired of Mr. Le Duc Tho which we should deal with -- the nine points or the seven points and Mr. Le Duc Tho said the nine points were more significant -- the ones we had gotten secretly. In view of that response, it was very difficult for us to deal publicly with the seven points of Madame Binh when we were told that the more significant points were the nine secret points given by Mr. Le Duc Tho.

- Despite the confusion that came from these different views, on August 16th, we made a formal eight point proposal which constituted our reply to the secret nine points, as well as a reply to the seven points made publicly by Madame Binh. In this reply in August, we actually

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went very far toward the seven and nine points of the other side and even included their specific language in our proposal on several of the key points.

. On September 13th, Dr. Kissinger again went to Paris secretly. On this occasion, as on the preceding occasion in August, Mr. Le Duc Tho found it inconvenient to come from Hanoi to meet with Mr. Kissinger and, instead, he met with Mr. Xuan Thuy. Nevertheless, at this meeting, Mr. Xuan Thuy rejected two of the eight points Dr. Kissinger had forwarded in August. As a result of this rejection, we then reformulated those two points and submitted eight new points on October 11. Of those eight points, six are identical to those already accepted by Hanoi, and the other two points constituted reformulation of the points which Hanoi had rejected in September.

. We then requested a secret meeting on November 1. As I pointed out earlier, since then we have had no substantive reply or exchange from Hanoi. In our view, our proposal of October went as far as anyone could possibly go. So, we were faced with intransigence not after we struck North Vietnam in December but well before. Among the proposals we offered in October were the following:

1. A specific offer for a fixed date for the withdrawal of our forces.

2. The provisions for new elections six months after a peace treaty would be signed.

3. A specific offer that all American troops would be withdrawn one month before this election.

4. The specific offer that the President and the Vice President of Vietnam would resign one month before the election so that they would not run it.

In addition to this proposal, the United States reiterated to Hanoi and reiterates here, our readiness to accept a post-settlement nonaligned

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Southeast Asia. Specifically, what we visualized under our proposal would be the immediate signature of a statement of principles by both sides on which a settlement would be based. We would then withdraw all American forces except a few thousand within seven months of the signing of these principles. And we would do this even before the signature of a final peace treaty. There is also the provision for an all-around cease-fire and the resignation one month before the election of President Thieu and his Vice President. Therefore, in the broadest sense we feel we have replied positively to every demand that Hanoi has made that is reasonable and does not constitute a direct humiliation of the United States as a world power. It is this sequence of events which has led to the conclusion on our part that the war continues in Southeast Asia only for Soviet aims. Certainly, no Asian power or no patriotic Vietnamese element can fear our eventual domination. It is interesting that just this week we have learned that New Delhi is going to upgrade its representation in Hanoi very soon. And certainly this is an ominous further clarification of what Soviet aims must be along the southern flank of the People's Republic of China. I will not elaborate further on this topic during my visit but I would hope that there could be some very frank exchange of views on some of the more recent indications of increased Soviet strategy of encirclement.

Now, also during Tuesday morning's meeting, the Prime Minister raised the December 16, 1971 issue of the Japanese Weekly Shuhan Gendai, a copy of which was furnished to me yesterday (attached). This was an article allegedly written by the Director of Propaganda for the Democratic Socialist Party of Japan. The article also allegedly portrayed the substance of a discussion between Mr. Kasuga and Dr. Kissinger in Washington. As I confirmed on Tuesday morning to the Prime Minister, Dr. Kissinger had met with Mr. Kasuga in Washington. However, that meeting lasted just 30 minutes, not two hours as the article indicates. During the meeting, Mr. Kasuga raised several questions associated with the President's visit here to Peking and persisted strongly in attempting to get some U.S. view on Taiwan from Dr. Kissinger. I have informed Dr. Kissinger of the contents of this article following the discussion Tuesday morning with the Prime Minister, and he has replied by providing me with a text of the precise minutes of his meeting with Mr. Kasuga. Dr. Kissinger also has

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reiterated personally to me, in addition to providing me with the minutes, that he gave no reply to Mr. Kasuga with respect to the future status of Taiwan. My personal review of the minutes of that meeting confirm categorically that Dr. Kissinger deflected all questions on the subject. Instead, he referred to his press conference which occurred on the Tuesday before the December 3rd meeting with Mr. Kasuga and offered to give him a copy of that press conference, with which I know you are familiar. In commenting on the Japanese press article, Dr. Kissinger asked me to convey the following message to the Prime Minister. In Dr. Kissinger's view, the only press which is less reliable than our own is that of the Japanese. He also asked me to reiterate again what I stated on Tuesday morning to the Prime Minister and in somewhat more detail concerning our view on the future of Taiwan. Tuesday morning, I cited three specific policies of the United States with respect to Taiwan. Dr. Kissinger has reformulated these assurances in terms of five specific points. First, the United States will withdraw Southeast Asian-related forces within a reasonable period after the end of the Indochina war. Second, the United States will gradually withdraw the reminder of its forces as tensions ease. Third, the United States will give no support to the return of the Japanese presence in Formosa or to the introduction of Japanese troops in that location. Fourth, the United States will make no further reference to the status of Formosa as being undetermined. And, fifth, the United States will offer no encouragement to the so-called Taiwan independence movement. This is the essence of the guidance I have received from Dr. Kissinger and I think completes the response to all of the untended issues which arose on Tuesday morning.

FM Chi: First of all, I would like to thank General Haig for conveying Dr. Kissinger's message. And I will convey it to Premier Chou En-lai. And if Premier Chou En-lai has any considerations of any other discussions or any other messages we will further inform you. So, there is nothing further on our side.

Gen Haig: Very good.

(following as we were walking out)

FM Chi: After all the groups have finished their meetings, do you think there is any further need for a meeting between us?

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Gen Haig: I am just a little concerned about the networks portion. Everything else has gone beautifully and I think we are in very good shape. There are some unsettled problems in terms of television coverage. I am hoping it will be resolved this morning. If not, we may have to delay 24 hours. I hope this does not occur because I know this is a terrible burden on you and I am very anxious for us to finish on schedule.

FM Chi: I believe it may be solved very quickly. I do not believe there is any great obstruction.

Gen Haig: That group is commercially oriented. This is business to them. They are not conscious of the political details. I would hope they would not attempt to play your side off against us.

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